

1. How is professional ethics in social work understood?

As stipulated in Article 2 Circular 01/2017/TT-BLDTBXH In the field of social work, professional ethics is understood as the fundamental principles and values that shape the perceptions, attitudes, and behaviors of those working in this field, corresponding to the specific nature of social work. This is not merely a set of criteria, but also a collection of guiding principles and norms that help build a solid and sustainable foundation for the proper development of this profession.



Social workers are not only those who perform assigned tasks but also active contributors to improving the quality of life and society. Therefore, their adherence to professional ethics is not only a personal responsibility but also a commitment to the community and society. The first principle of social work ethics is respect for and protection of people's rights. This includes listening to and understanding the needs, desires, and individual characteristics of each person in the community. A positive work environment must be built, while ensuring fairness and equality in the provision of social services.

Another principle is actively participating in self-training and development, not only in professional knowledge but also in ethical values. Continuously improving professional quality will enhance professionalism and talent, and also

create individuals who bring positive and sustainable value to the community. In total, professional ethics in social work is not only an important aspect of the profession but also a crucial asset in achieving the noblest goal: building an increasingly developed, equitable, and harmonious society.

2. Fundamental principles when conducting social work today

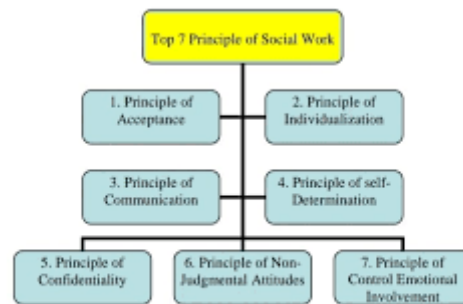


Figure: Top 7 Principle of Social Work

Article 3 of Circular 01/2017/TT-BLDTBXH stipulates the basic principles for carrying out social work today as follows:

- Respect and empower the choices and decisions of our clients. These guidelines are not just routine actions, but opportunities to connect deeply with the core values of the social work profession. We are not just mentors, but also inspirers, encouraging clients to maximize the power of their diversity.
- The second principle is not just about encouraging the full participation of the target audience, but also guiding them towards a journey of self-determination and problem-solving. This is not only about enabling them to shape their lives, but also about sharing unwavering belief in their abilities and taking responsibility for their decisions. Through this approach, a safe and supportive space is created where creativity and innovation can emerge from the target audience themselves.
- Regarding the third principle, it's not just about focusing on the strengths and leveraging the available resources of the target group, but also about building an

environment that encourages creativity. It's about being not just supporters, but also facilitators of development and empowerment. In this way, we not only help them overcome challenges, but also help them realize their hidden potential, opening new doors for personal and community development.

- The fourth principle establishes a profound vision of responsibility for all professional activities in social work. It's not just about performing tasks as required, but also about being accountable for ensuring that all services provided are appropriate and of high quality. Through dedication and responsibility, it ensures that each individual receives not only support but also experiences the utmost care and respect.

- The fifth principle focuses not only on ensuring social justice but also extends its vision to providing resources fairly and transparently. By meeting the real needs of the target group, it not only helps them achieve their personal goals but also promotes fairness within the community. In this way, it contributes to building a society that improves the quality of life and creates equal opportunities for everyone.

- The sixth principle places a broad vision of diversity and respect, without discrimination in any aspect of the subject. It is not just about service providers, but also about ethical leaders creating an open and accepting environment for diversity. It is not about focusing solely on ability, age, gender, or any other characteristic, but placing respect and equality at the heart of all relationships and decisions. Through this approach, strong bridges are built between different social strata, fostering consensus and understanding.

3. Responsibility for compiling guidelines on professional ethics for social work.

Article 6 of Circular 01/2017/TT-BLDTBXH stipulates that the Ministry of Labour, Invalids and Social Affairs is facing a crucial responsibility: not only to preside over but also to coordinate with other ministries, sectors, localities, and political and social organizations to manage, train, and utilize social workers. In this context, their task extends beyond meeting ethical standards for social work; it also includes promoting consensus and overall work efficiency.

To make social work a flexible and progressive profession, the Ministry of Labour, Invalids and Social Affairs not only plays a managerial role but also takes the lead in organizing the compilation and training of guidelines on professional ethical standards. In this way, they not only define expectations but also create conditions for social workers to develop and work effectively, understanding fundamental ethical values.

Furthermore, the Ministry's inspection and auditing tasks are not merely a form of routine supervision, but also an opportunity to ensure that professional ethical standards are strictly and consistently implemented across the entire industry. Through this process, they can not only detect and severely punish violations of professional ethics but also shape a positive work environment and accumulate experience to improve the industry.

The Ministry of Labour, Invalids and Social Affairs faces a crucial task: leading and organizing the compilation of guidelines on professional ethical standards in the field of social work. This responsibility is not merely an administrative task, but also an opportunity to create innovative, inspiring, and challenging materials that encourage social workers to strive for higher and transformative ethical standards.

Furthermore, this process opens up space for active participation from the social work community, from experienced professionals to newcomers. This diversity is a valuable resource for enriching and comprehensively developing guidelines, while fostering interaction and learning within the profession. Ultimately, this is not just about meeting formal requirements, but about creating a positive impetus, shaping the thinking and attitudes of social workers in a positive and creative direction. This not only impacts current social workers but also contributes to building a foundation for future generations of this profession.